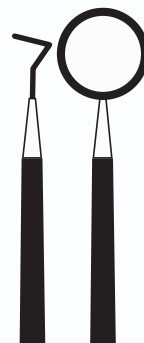




DENTIST

JOB DESCRIPTION

Dentists diagnose and treat damage, disease, and decay to the teeth, gums, and mouth, and provide cosmetic treatments to improve their appearance. They also educate and advise patients on effective cleaning techniques, mouth hygiene, and diet to maintain oral and dental health. Dentists might work in a hospital to carry out reconstructive surgery for patients with facial injuries, or perform routine dental care in a clinic.



SALARY

Newly qualified dentist ★★★★★

Senior dental practitioner ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Good job prospects and opportunities for career advancement • High salaries • Continued growth in demand for dental services • Strong competition for training programs and residencies

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Medicine • Biology • Chemistry • Physics • Biochemistry • Anatomy • English • Information Technology (IT) • Public health



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree in dentistry is required. Work experience, such as shadowing a dentist, will help when applying for courses.



LIFESTYLE Work hours vary by practice, and may include evening or weekend duties, and periods on call over public holidays.



LOCATION Most dentists work in a consulting room within a private dental practice, a hospital, or a clinic. Travel for work purposes is rare.



THE REALITIES Dentists might have to work with patients who are unhygienic or who have oral diseases. Some patients might become stressed during treatment.

CAREER PATHS

Aspiring dentist can expect to undergo years of extensive training. Most dentists work on a self-employed basis as general practice dentists, owning or being a partner in a clinic. Switching between general practice and hospital dentistry is less common.

UNDERGRADUATE If your grades do not meet the minimum level required for entry into dental school, you may find it helpful to take a year-long foundation course before applying again.



DENTAL SCHOOL GRADUATE You will need to take the Dental Admissions Test (DAT) and complete an accredited dental school program for a degree in dentistry in order to practice.

